The Jester's Court

Art asset requests for the art department

Everything the finished game needs that is currently a labelled shape, a placeholder or reused carnival art.

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How to deliver

Deliver the same way as the Jester, mace knight and bat knight sheets: one PNG sprite sheet per animation, frames in a grid, the character facing **right**, the same scale on every sheet of a character. The existing pipelines (`tools/art/process_*_sheets.py`) key the background, split the grid, align every frame on the feet (or body centre for flyers) and build the Godot animations, so loose generator output is fine; clean transparent PNGs are better.

Rule	Detail
Resolution	Author at **2x** the in-game size listed (the game draws at 0.5 with mipmaps). Example: the Arbalest is 92 px tall in game, so draw it about 184 px tall.
Background	Transparent PNG preferred. Flat white/near-white or checker also works (the pipeline keys it). Avoid painted ground shadows, captions and motion lines - or keep them clearly detached so they are dropped.
Framing	Leave padding around each frame; keep effects that belong to a frame inside its cell. Same camera distance on every sheet.
Facing	Right-facing only. The game mirrors.
Anchor	Ground characters: feet on a common baseline. Flyers: body centre. Bosses: feet.
Frame counts	The numbers given are guides. Attack frames are picked from the gameplay phase (windup / active / recover), so tell us which frames belong to which phase.
Readability	Every windup must read as a warning at 1080p from across a room. Weak points (Bulwark's back, Colossus's head) must be obvious.
Palette	Vivid, moonlit carnival; each area has its own tint (see the stand-in screenshots). Ink outlines like the Jester.
Tiles	Terrain tiles as in the current pack: 128 px authored squares, top-surface variants and body variants, seamless.
Naming	`<id>_<animation>.png`, e.g. `EN-01_windup.png`. Put them in assets/source/<name>/sheets/.

Priorities

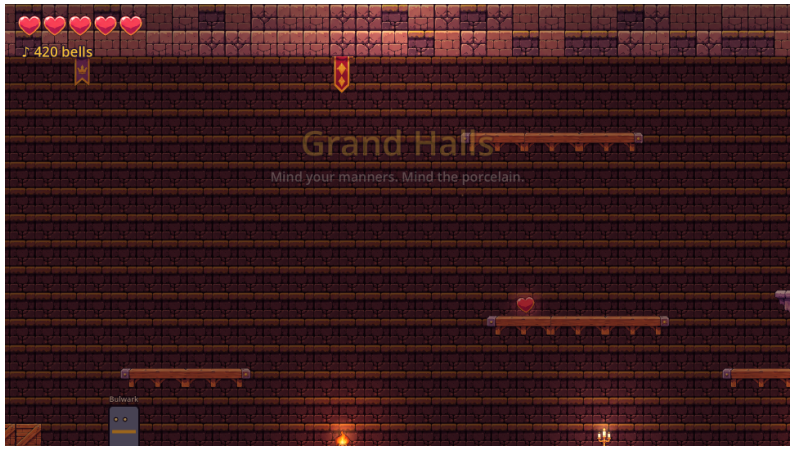
P1 - needed to ship (the game still shows a labelled shape or the wrong area's art). **P2** - strongly wanted for polish. **P3** - nice to have.

What the stand-ins look like today

Everything below is in the game and playable. Labelled shapes mark every character still waiting for art; the tint and lighting per area are final-ish and show the intended mood.







Left: all six bosses mid-fight (stand-ins). Right: Royal Gardens and Grand Halls rooms with enemy stand-ins.

1. Bosses (P1)

Six bosses, each with three health phases. Sizes are in-game pixels at 1080p (draw at 2x). Every attack has a telegraph in code; the art should sell the windup.

ID	Boss	Area	Size	Look & behaviour	Animations needed
BS-01	The Ringmaster	Carnival Gate	96 x 176	Top hat, red tailcoat, whip. Theatrical. Throws flaming hoops, cartwheels across the ring, leaps and slams; summons balloon clowns late.	intro pose, idle, walk, whip crack (windup 0.55 s + crack), hoop throw, cartwheel (loop), dizzy (after wall), leap/land, summon, hurt flash, phase change, death
BS-02	The Executioner	Outer Walls	130 x 210	Hooded giant with a huge axe. Slow, telegraphed chops; armoured whirlwind; leap slam; returning axe throw.	intro, idle, walk, chop windup (0.8 s) + chop, whirlwind (loop), leap/land, axe throw/catch, phase change, death; AXE projectile (spinning, 4 frames)
BS-03	The Mourning Bell	Royal Gardens	190 x 210 (flies)	A floating bronze funeral bell, overgrown with roses, with a sorrowful face. Tolls shockwaves, drops to crush, gets stuck in the soil.	hover (loop), toll (windup + ring), rise, drop, stuck/struggle (loop), pendulum swing, summon wisps, phase change (cracks appear), death (shatter)
BS-04	The Acrobat Twins (Pim & Pom)	Grand Halls	76 x 140 each	Two mirrored acrobats sharing one health bar: Pim (blue) and Pom (pink). Tumble, throw knives, dive from the ceiling.	per twin: intro, idle, tumble (loop), knife throw, ceiling spring, dive, land, hurt, death; KNIFE projectile
BS-05	The Clockwork Colossus	Clockworks	230 x 330	Towering automaton. Its plating only cracks from ABOVE: the head/shoulders must read as the weak point (glowing seams). Fist slams, steam vents, gear volleys, stomps.	idle (gears turning), fist slam L/R (windup + impact), vent steam, gear launch, stomp, hurt (upper body only), phase change (armour falls away), death (collapse)
BS-06	The King	Throne Spire	110 x 196	The villain. Pompous, petty, terrified of a joke. Act 1 sceptre + crown boomerang + card fans; Act 2 calls guards and blinks; Act 3 takes to the air on a flying throne/cape and rains cards.	intro, idle, sceptre strike, crown throw/catch, card fan, blink, summon, airborne idle, swoop, rain cast, phase changes (2), defeat (laughing - he finally gets the joke)

2. Enemies (P1)

Ten new enemy types plus final art for the Court Guard. The mace knight and bat knight are already done. All enemies can be launched, so each needs a tumbling 'launched' pose and a lying 'knocked down' frame.

ID	Enemy	Where	Size	Look & behaviour	Animations needed
EN-01	Arbalest	Outer Walls, Throne Spire	54 x 92	Crossbow guard who keeps distance. Must read aim clearly: the windup is a 0.7 s aim pose; the bolt is batted back by the player.	idle, walk/move, windup (attack anticipation), attack (active), recover, hurt, launched (tumbling, 1-2 frames), knocked down (lying, 1 frame), death; plus aim (held) and reload
EN-02	Bulwark	Outer Walls, Grand Halls, King's court	70 x 104	Tower-shield bearer. The shield must be unmistakably in FRONT: hits from the front clank off, hits from above/behind land.	idle, walk/move, windup (attack anticipation), attack (active), recover, hurt, launched (tumbling, 1-2 frames), knocked down (lying, 1 frame), death; plus block (shield spark), shield bash
EN-03	Springer	Carnival Gate, Gardens	50 x 66	Jack-in-the-box on a coil that bounces toward the player in big arcs.	idle, crouch (windup), spring (airborne, 2-3), land squash, hurt, launched, death
EN-04	Gargoyle Hound	Outer Walls, Clockworks	92 x 52	Stone dog. Growls (windup), then charges flat out and stuns itself on walls.	idle, walk, growl (windup), run (charge, 6), skid, dazed (wall stun), hurt, launched, death
EN-05	Wisp	Royal Gardens	52 x 52 (flying)	Drifting garden ghost-light; lobs slow homing orbs.	float (6), cast (4), hurt, launched, death (fade/pop)
EN-06	Balloon Clown	Carnival Gate	70 x 70 (flying)	Clown face on a balloon that drops spiked juggling balls. 1 HP: pops. Prime pogo target.	float (4), drop (3), pop death (4)
EN-07	Siege Cannon	Outer Walls, Clockworks	96 x 70	Stationary cannon on wheels (optionally crewed by a tiny gnome). Fires arcing cannonballs.	idle, aim/recoil windup, fire (3, with muzzle flash), hurt, destroyed
EN-08	Inquisitor	Grand Halls, Throne Spire	56 x 110	Robed caster. Blinks around the player, casts orb fans and pillars of judgement.	idle, cast fan (windup+release), cast pillar, blink out / in (3+3), hurt, launched, death
EN-09	Porcelain Courtier	Grand Halls	48 x 88	Doll-like noble that moves in stiff ticks and pirouettes. Shatters on death.	idle, tick-step walk (4), pirouette (6), hurt, launched, shatter death (5)
EN-10	Clockwork Knight	Clockworks	72 x 112	Wind-up automaton with blade arms. Spins (armoured), then must rewind its key (wide open).	idle, walk, wind-up, spin (6, loop), wind-down/key turn (6), hurt, launched, death
EN-11	Court Guard (real art)	Everywhere	~48 x 104	Replaces the Community Aide stand-in. Halberd lunge attack.	idle, walk/move, windup (attack anticipation), attack (active), recover, hurt, launched (tumbling, 1-2 frames), knocked down (lying, 1 frame), death

3. Characters, NPCs and Jester additions

ID	Character	Where	Size	Look	Animations	Priority
NPC-01	Pippet (shopkeeper)	All 6 shops, 3 NPC rooms	~44 x 70	Small, nervous goblin-ish court page with a rickety bell cart (the cart can stay the pack's cart.png). Blue livery.	idle (4-6), talk (4), happy/sale (3), wave (4)	P1
NPC-02	The Court Spook	NPC rooms, all areas	~56 x 76 (floats)	Friendly bell-shaped ghost, teal and translucent, with a jester collar. Speaks in hints.	float idle (6), talk (4), giggle (4)	P1
NPC-03	Princess Seraphine	Ending cards only	Illustration	The only royal who laughs. Appears in the ending story card.	Illustration only	P2

Jester: new animations for the earned abilities

ID	Animation	Frames	Priority
JS-01	Wall slide + wall bounce	slide (2-3 loop), kick off (3)	P1
JS-02	Phantom Step dash	ghost dash pose (can reuse dash with a variant palette)	P2
JS-03	Shrine rest / interact	sit/bow at shrine (4), read sign / talk (2)	P2
JS-04	Ability get	triumphant hammer raise (4-6)	P2
JS-05	Ending bow	deep theatrical bow (6)	P2
JS-06	Drop through ledge	brief crouch (2)	P3

4. Environments

The castle has six areas. Only the Carnival Gate has its own art; the other five reuse the carnival tile pack with a colour tint. Each area needs its own terrain set, back wall, backdrop and props.

ID	Asset	Description	Priority
ENV-01	Outer Walls terrain set	Ramparts: cold blue-grey stone, battlements, arrow slits, iron braces. Same tile format as the existing pack (128 px authored, 7 top variants, 5 body variants, cracked, ledges).	P1
ENV-02	Royal Gardens terrain set	Hedges, trellises, mossy marble, rose vines; overgrown, moonlit, a little funereal.	P1
ENV-03	Grand Halls terrain set	Polished parquet and marble, gilded trim, carpet runners, porcelain display plinths.	P1
ENV-04	Clockworks terrain set	Riveted brass and iron, catwalk grates, pipes; warm orange furnace light.	P1
ENV-05	Throne Spire terrain set	Royal purple stone, gold leaf, stained glass, velvet; gets grander toward the top.	P1
ENV-06	Back walls x5 (one per area)	Tileable background wall per area (currently a darkened stone tile). 512 x 512 seamless.	P1
ENV-07	Parallax backdrops x5	Far + mid layers per area in the format of the Carnival Gate set (castle silhouette, gardens, hall interiors through arches, clock gears, spire skyline). Width tiles horizontally, ~2048 x 1100.	P2
ENV-08	Area props x6-10 per area	Wall decor that hangs from ceilings or stands on floors: banners, lanterns, candelabras, topiary, statues, portraits, gears, pipes, stained-glass windows.	P2
ENV-09	Cracked stone block	Breakable by Cracking Slam (64 x 64 tile, plus 6-frame break). Must read as 'breakable' at a glance in every area.	P1
ENV-10	Spectral barrier	Ghostly wall the Phantom Step passes through (64 x 64 tile, looping shimmer 6). Currently a procedural shimmer.	P1
ENV-11	Boss portcullis	Iron gate that slams shut over doors during boss fights; drop + rise (4 + 4).	P2
ENV-12	Spikes per area	64 px strip, 6 variants (one per area).	P2
ENV-13	Spring / bounce pad	Rest + compress + launch (4).	P2
ENV-14	Ladder-ledge variants	One-way ledges per area (current ledges are carnival wood/stone).	P2

Area mood references (current lighting): Carnival Gate - moonlit festival pinks; Outer Walls - cold blue night; Royal Gardens - green moonlight, roses; Grand Halls - warm candlelit amber; Clockworks - orange furnace glow; Throne Spire - royal purple and gold.

5. Projectiles

Every enemy shot can be hit back by the hammer, so shots need to be readable and 'hittable'. A gold reflected tint is applied in code.

ID	Projectile	Used by	Size	Frames
PR-01	Crossbow bolt	Arbalest	~44 x 10	2 frames + reflected (gold) tint is done in code
PR-02	Homing orb	Wisp, Inquisitor	~28	4-frame loop; teal (wisp) and pink (inquisitor) variants
PR-03	Spiked juggling ball	Balloon Clown	~32	spinning loop 4
PR-04	Cannonball	Siege Cannon	~40	1-2 frames + smoke trail
PR-05	Flaming hoop	Ringmaster	~52	4-frame flame loop
PR-06	Executioner's axe	Executioner	~80	spin loop 4
PR-07	Throwing knife	Acrobat Twins	~30 x 8	1-2 frames
PR-08	Gear	Colossus	~44	spin loop 4
PR-09	Playing card	King	~28 x 40	flip loop 4
PR-10	Crown boomerang	King	~60	spin loop 4
PR-11	Ground shockwave	Bosses, Cracking Slam	~48 x 48 travelling	4-frame loop

6. Interactables and pickups

ID	Object	Description	Priority
OB-01	Shrine of the Grin	Rest point: save, heal, swap charms. Grinning jester bust on a plinth with candles. Idle glow loop + activate flash.	P1
OB-02	Ability altar	Appears after each boss; holds a glowing orb with the new trick. Idle + claim burst.	P1
OB-03	Seal door	Throne Spire gate with five seals (one per champion). States: 0-5 seals lit, open.	P1
OB-04	Ending throne	The empty throne the Jester takes a bow at.	P2
OB-05	Sign post	Readable wooden sign (per area tint is fine).	P2
OB-06	Heart piece	Collectible quarter-heart, bobbing; 4 make a heart. Idle shine loop 6.	P1
OB-07	Lost joke page	Torn page from the Jester's joke book. Flutter loop 6.	P1
OB-08	Bell (currency)	Small jester bell, spin loop 4, plus a bell cache (pile/chest) pickup.	P1

7. UI

All menus and HUD are built in code with a placeholder theme and the engine's default font.

ID	Asset	Description	Priority
UI-01	Game logo / title lettering	'The Jester's Court' for the title screen (transparent PNG, ~1600 px wide).	P1
UI-02	Fonts	Display font for titles/banners and a readable body font (licensed for commercial use; OTF/TTF).	P1
UI-03	HUD hearts	Full, empty, breaking (4) and quarter-piece indicator. Current heart is the pack heart.	P1
UI-04	Bell counter icon	Small bell icon for the HUD.	P1
UI-05	Ability icons x5	Hammer Twirl, Hammer Vault, Cracking Slam, Wall Bounce, Phantom Step.	P1
UI-06	Charm icons x9	Rubber Nose, Juggler's Gloves, Lucky Bell, Heavy Head, Spring Heels, Cartwheel, Thick Skull, Pratfall, Encore.	P1
UI-07	Menu frame kit	9-slice panel, button (normal/hover/focus/pressed/disabled), slider, checkbox, in the court style.	P2
UI-08	Map icons	Shrine, shop, boss, friend, heart piece, player marker; room fill per area.	P2
UI-09	Boss health bar frame	Ornate frame + fill + damage-lag fill.	P2
UI-10	Input prompts	Keyboard and gamepad glyphs for E/Y interact, etc.	P3

8. Story illustrations (P2)

Minimal story: an intro and an ending, each six full-screen cards. Text is already written (scripts/systems/story.gd).

ID	Asset	Description
ST-01..06	Intro cards x6	One illustration per intro line: the Fool's joke, the King not laughing, the moat, the festival moon a year later, the grin climbing out, 'the punchline is upstairs'. 1920 x 1080.
ST-07..12	Ending cards x6	Crown rolling, Seraphine laughing, the whole Court laughing, the King finally laughing, the bow, curtain down. 1920 x 1080.
ST-13	Title background	Optional painted key art for the title screen (currently the Carnival Gate sky).

9. Effects (P2-P3)

ID	Effect	Description
FX-01	Parry flash	Gold ring + sparkle when a shot is batted back.
FX-02	Phantom Step trail	Ghostly afterimage tint/streak for the ghost dash.
FX-03	Shockwave ring	Ground ring for Cracking Slam / boss slams (current ring.png is a placeholder).
FX-04	Steam column	Colossus vents, looping 6 frames, ~110 x 900.

ID	Effect	Description
FX-05	Judgement pillar	Inquisitor's light pillar, 6 frames, ~120 x 420.
FX-06	Telegraph textures	Optional: patterned warning zones to replace the flat flashing rectangles.
FX-07	Area motes	Optional sprites for ambient particles per area (petals, dust, embers, sparks).

Not needed from art

Music, ambience and every sound effect are synthesised in code (tools/audio/synth.py) and already in the game. If the audio team wants to replace them, the file names in assets/audio/ are the contract: drop in an OGG with the same name. Lighting, screen shake, slow motion, flashes, telegraph timing and all particles are code-driven.

Questions for the creative director

- Pippet and the Court Spook: are these the right two recurring NPCs, or should one be a known character from the Bible?

- The King's Act 3 flight: flying throne, cape glide, or carried by guards? The code only needs 'airborne' poses.

- Should the five areas keep the carnival tile shapes (only re-skinned) or get new silhouettes? New shapes are fine; collision is generated, not drawn.